

NatGen Auditor Handbook

National General File Handling & Estimate Compliance Guide

Version 1.2 | Internal Training Document

How to Read This Document

✓ BEST PRACTICE

Indicates a best practice or compliant approach that reduces revision risk.

⚠ CAUTION

Something to watch closely — this area generates frequent carrier questions.

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

High-risk area. Files submitted with these issues are very likely to be revised.

i NOTE

General information, exceptions, or procedural notes.

Table of Contents

1. Purpose
 2. Core Principles
 3. When Opening a File
 4. Inspection Requirements
 5. Photo Documentation Requirements
 6. Estimate Writing Guidelines
 7. Parts Guidelines
 8. Estimate Line Compliance
 9. Labor Rates
 10. Sublet and Invoice Documentation
 11. Repair Facility Information
 12. Tax Configuration
 13. Total Loss Handling
 14. Hail Claim Guidelines
 15. Common Revision Triggers
 16. Carrier Revision Phrases — Heat Map
 17. Pre-Submission Checklist
 18. Quality Expectations
 19. Auditor Responsibility
 20. Questions & Escalations
 21. Final Reminder
-

1. Purpose

This handbook provides auditors with standardized procedures for handling National General (NatGen) appraisal assignments.

The goal is to:

- reduce carrier revisions
- ensure estimate compliance
- maintain documentation standards
- improve cycle time
- protect auditor performance metrics

NatGen files are heavily audited by the carrier. Most revisions are triggered by estimate scope issues, documentation gaps, or administrative errors. This guide focuses on preventing those issues.

2. Core Principles

The NatGen Golden Rule

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY
IF THE PHOTOS DON'T SHOW IT, DO NOT WRITE IT

Every line on the estimate must be supported by:

- visible damage
- necessary repair operations
- documentation or photos

Unsupported estimate lines are the #1 cause of revisions.

State Guidelines Trump Carrier Guidelines

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY
State regulations always take precedence over carrier guidelines. When state law and carrier policy conflict, follow state law. If you are unsure which applies, contact Rachael or Tommy before proceeding.

3. When Opening a File

Before writing a single line on any estimate, complete these steps in order.

Step 1 — Change the Profile

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

The very first thing you must do when opening a file is change the profile to ensure the correct threshold and PDR matrix are applied. This must happen before any estimate work begins.

Verify the profile confirms:

- Total loss threshold is set correctly for the state and carrier
- PDR matrix is loaded and active

Step 2 — Do Not Overrule Labor Rates

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Never overrule the labor rates populated by CCC. Labor rates are pre-configured and must not be manually changed. Overruling labor rates will cause carrier corrections.

If labor rates appear incorrect, contact Rachael or Tommy before making any changes. Do not adjust them yourself.

4. Inspection Requirements

NatGen requires physical inspections for most assignments.

Required

- ✓ Original inspections
- ✓ Supplement inspections
- ✓ Shop inspections

Exceptions

i NOTE

Small supplements may skip inspection only if: (1) the supplement is a part price difference only, and (2) invoice documentation is provided.

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

If an in-person inspection cannot be completed — reject the assignment.

5. Photo Documentation Requirements

Vehicle Identification

Required photos:

- VIN photo on door or door jamb
- Production date label
- Odometer

i NOTE

If odometer cannot be photographed, document an alternative: oil change sticker, last known mileage from owner, or a written note in the summary.

Damage Documentation

Photos must clearly show:

- Damage panel
- Impact area
- Damage severity
- Adjacent panels

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Poor photos are a direct path to revision requests, re-inspections, and back charges. Document everything thoroughly.

6. Estimate Writing Guidelines

Estimates should follow best-case repair methodology when inspected at residences.

✓ BEST PRACTICE

Residence inspections are preliminary estimates — not full tear-down estimates. Default to repair, minimal paint, and avoid unnecessary blends.

7. Parts Guidelines

Parts selection is one of the most frequently revised areas on NatGen files. Follow these rules precisely.

OEM Parts — Strict Criteria

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

OEM parts may only be used when BOTH of the following criteria are met: (1) the vehicle is the current model year, AND (2) the vehicle has fewer than 15,000 miles. Both must be true. If either condition is not met, OEM is not appropriate.

Alternate Parts — When OEM Does Not Qualify

If the vehicle is over the current model year OR over 15,000 miles, utilize parts in this order:

- LKQ (Like Kind and Quality) recycled parts
- Remanufactured parts
- Aftermarket parts

⚠ CAUTION

No recon parts as a default sourcing choice. Alternate parts must be actively sourced and documented in the estimate.

8. Estimate Line Compliance

Repair vs Replace

⚠ CAUTION

Default to repair. Replace must be justified by severe damage, safety concerns, or documented repair impracticality.

Common replace revisions occur on: bumper covers, fenders, outer panels, and door skins.

Blend Panels

⚠ CAUTION

Avoid blending when color match is likely, panel separation exists, or the repair area is minimal. Blends must be necessary — not routine.

Paint Scope

✖ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Large paint scopes frequently trigger revisions. Watch for unnecessary adjacent panel refinish, excess clear coat, and unnecessary mask/setup lines.

Paint operations must align with the actual damage area.

R&I Operations

Each R&I line must be justified by repair access, part replacement, or refinish necessity.

⚠ CAUTION

Do not add R&I lines that do not directly support the repair work being performed.

9. Labor Rates

Labor rates in CCC are pre-configured for each carrier and market. They must not be manually overridden.

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Do not overrule labor rates. They are set by the carrier and CCC profile. Changing them manually will result in a carrier correction.

Hero & Altavara — Tax Purposes

i NOTE

Hero and Altavara are utilized for tax purposes within the labor rate configuration. These are set at the profile level and should not be altered.

If you encounter a labor rate that appears incorrect or does not match the assignment location, contact Rachael or Tommy before taking any action.

10. Sublet and Invoice Documentation

All sublet charges require supporting documentation. Common sublets include: scan/calibration, alignment, glass work, towing, and storage.

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Every sublet charge requires a supporting invoice. Without documentation, the carrier will remove or revise the charge.

Mechanical Sublets from Dealers

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Mechanical sublet invoices from dealerships must be broken down by operation. A single-line invoice total is not acceptable — each operation must be itemized separately.

Dealer Part Numbers

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

When a dealer replaces parts, the part numbers for all replaced parts must be present in the estimate. Estimates without dealer part numbers will be revised.

11. Repair Facility Information

Required fields on every estimate:

- Shop name
- Shop address
- Phone number
- Registration number (where required)

i NOTE

If no repair facility is involved, enter: Owner's Choice

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Incomplete shop information is one of the most common and most avoidable revision triggers.

12. Tax Configuration

Before locking an estimate, verify the Rates tab in CCC.

- Tax rate matches the ZIP code
- Tax categories are applied correctly

⚠ CAUTION

Incorrect tax configuration causes frequent carrier corrections. Always verify before submission. Hero and Altavara handle tax configuration at the profile level — do not manually adjust.

13. Total Loss Handling

NatGen requires NADA valuation for total loss review. Watch for:

- Repair cost nearing vehicle value
- Major structural damage
- Severe flood exposure

NADA Valuation — Normal Trade-In Only

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Always use the NADA Normal Trade-In value. Do not use Clean Retail. Using Clean Retail inflates the vehicle value and is incorrect for NatGen total loss evaluation.

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Borderline total loss files must be handled carefully. Do not authorize repair if the vehicle may be a total loss — attach NADA and escalate.

14. Hail Claim Guidelines

Residence Inspection Philosophy

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

NatGen hail inspections at a residence must be conservative estimates. PDR (Paintless Dent Repair) is the preferred repair philosophy. Write toward PDR first — do not write conventional repair lines at a residence unless clearly necessary.

Hail Photo Requirements

All hail damage must be photographed using a striped board or checker board. Photos must clearly show dent locations.

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Hail photos without a board are insufficient and will trigger a revision.

PDR Guidelines

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

Initial residence inspections must use the CCC PDR Matrix. Manual PDR line entries are not allowed.

Hail Repair Restrictions

Initial residence estimates cannot include:

- Aluminum panel markups
- Glue pull markups
- Oversized dent markups

i NOTE

These repairs may be considered later at the repair facility — not at the residence inspection.

Windshield Replacement

⚠ CAUTION

Replacement is only supported when hail directly caused the break. Rock chips do not qualify.

15. Common Revision Triggers

The most frequent NatGen revisions occur due to:

1. unsupported repair operations
2. aggressive replace decisions
3. unnecessary blend panels
4. missing invoices for sublet work
5. single-line dealer mechanical invoices
6. missing dealer part numbers
7. incorrect OEM parts usage
8. missing shop information
9. incorrect tax configuration
10. incomplete photo documentation
11. labor rate overrides
12. NADA Clean Retail used instead of Normal Trade-In

⚠ CAUTION

Review this list before every submission. If you are unsure about any area, reach out before submitting — not after.

16. Carrier Revision Phrases — Heat Map

These are the exact phrases NatGen uses when revising files. Recognizing the language helps auditors understand what went wrong and how to prevent it.

Carrier Revision Phrase	What It Usually Means	Estimate Trigger	Prevention	Risk
"Damage not supported by photos."	Operation not justified	Repair/replace written without visible damage	Ensure every estimate line has a supporting photo	HIGH
"Please review repair vs replace."	Replace too aggressive	Bumper / fender / outer panel replacement	Default to repair when possible	HIGH
"Blend panel not supported."	Blend unnecessary	Adjacent panel blend added	Avoid blends unless absolutely necessary	HIGH
"Scan charge requires invoice."	Documentation missing	Pre/post scan line without invoice	Upload scan invoice before submitting	HIGH
"Sublet requires documentation."	Sublet unsupported	Alignment / calibration / glass without invoice	Always attach supporting invoice	HIGH
"OEM part not supported."	Alt parts expected	OEM used outside current model year / under 15k	Both criteria must be met to use OEM	HIGH
"Repair total approaching TL threshold."	Potential total loss	Estimate near vehicle value	Use NADA Normal Trade-In; escalate if near threshold	HIGH
"Shop information missing."	Header incomplete	Supplement missing shop info	Fill out shop name, address, and phone on every file	HIGH
"Odometer documentation required."	Mileage proof missing	Odometer photo absent	Upload odometer or document an acceptable alternative	MEDIUM
"VIN photo required."	Vehicle ID incomplete	VIN label photo missing	Capture VIN on door or door jamb	MEDIUM
"Paint scope excessive."	Refinish too large	Multiple blends / excessive refinish panels	Limit paint scope to the actual damage area	HIGH
"Body shop supplies not allowed."	Invalid line item	Shop supplies line on estimate	Remove supplies charge	MEDIUM
"Frame operation not supported."	Frame work questionable	Frame hours written without documentation	Provide measurements or remove the line	MEDIUM
"PDR matrix required."	Hail estimate incorrect	Manual PDR entries used	Use CCC PDR Matrix only	HIGH

Carrier Revision Phrase	What It Usually Means	Estimate Trigger	Prevention	Risk
"Tax configuration incorrect."	Rates tab error	Tax not applied properly to ZIP	Verify tax configuration before locking	MEDIUM

Revision Frequency by Category

From analyzing revision data across multiple NatGen files, the majority of revisions fall into five buckets:

Category	Approximate Frequency
Photo support issues	Very High
Repair vs replace	High
Paint scope / blends	High
Missing invoices	Moderate
Administrative errors	Moderate

✓ BEST PRACTICE

Photo support issues and repair vs replace decisions account for the largest share of revisions. Mastering those two areas alone will dramatically reduce your revision rate.

17. Pre-Submission Checklist

Before submitting a NatGen file, verify:

- ✓ Profile changed — threshold and PDR matrix confirmed
- ✓ Labor rates not overridden
- ✓ State guidelines checked for this assignment
- ✓ VIN photo present
- ✓ Odometer documented
- ✓ Damage supported by photos
- ✓ Parts sourced correctly per OEM/LKQ criteria
- ✓ Shop information completed
- ✓ Tax configuration verified
- ✓ Sublet invoices attached
- ✓ Dealer mechanical sublet broken down by operation
- ✓ Dealer part numbers present
- ✓ NADA Normal Trade-In attached when required

✓ **BEST PRACTICE**

Every item on this list represents a real revision trigger. Do not skip it.

18. Quality Expectations

NatGen expects files to be accurate, documented, and compliant with guidelines.

Auditors should prioritize:

- documentation
- realistic repair methodology
- estimate clarity

✓ **BEST PRACTICE**

High-quality files reduce revision requests, cycle time delays, and carrier escalations.

19. Auditor Responsibility

Each auditor is responsible for:

- accurate estimate writing
- proper documentation
- adherence to carrier and state guidelines
- responding to revision requests

Failure to follow guidelines may result in reassignment, back charges, or performance review.

20. Questions & Escalations

If anything on a file is questionable or something does not seem right, do not guess — reach out for clarification before submitting.

✓ **BEST PRACTICE**

When in doubt, contact Rachael or Tommy. They can get clarification for you.

This applies to any situation including:

- unusual damage patterns
- unfamiliar claim types
- borderline total loss scenarios
- unclear carrier or state instructions
- labor rate or profile questions

- anything that does not feel right

It is always better to ask first than to submit a file that requires a revision.

21. Final Reminder

The best way to avoid NatGen revisions is simple. Write estimates that are:

- supported
- reasonable
- documented

✗ HIGH RISK — REVISION LIKELY

If the photos do not show it, do not write it.

NatGen Quick Reference — Pre-Submission Cheat Sheet

Keep this page open while writing estimates.

AREA	WHAT TO CHECK	RISK
File Setup	Change profile first — verify threshold and PDR matrix are correct. Do not overrule labor rates.	HIGH
State Rules	State guidelines always trump carrier guidelines. Check state-specific requirements first.	HIGH
Photos	VIN, odometer, damage panel, impact area, adjacent panels all documented	HIGH
Estimate Support	Every line backed by visible damage — nothing written that is not shown	HIGH
Repair vs Replace	Default to repair; replace only with documented justification	HIGH
Parts — OEM	OEM only if current model year AND under 15k miles — both criteria must be met	HIGH
Parts — Alt	Over model year OR over 15k miles: use LKQ, Recon, or Aftermarket. No recon parts as default.	HIGH
Blend Panels	Only blend when necessary for color match; avoid if panel separation exists	MEDIUM
Paint Scope	No unnecessary adjacent panel refinish, excess clear coat, or mask/setup lines	MEDIUM
R&I Operations	Each R&I directly supports repair access, part replacement, or refinish	MEDIUM
Labor Rates	Do not overrule labor rates in CCC profile. Hero & Altavara used for tax purposes.	HIGH
Dealer Sublets	Mechanical sublets from dealers must be broken down by operation — no single-line invoices	HIGH
Dealer Parts	Part numbers must be present on all parts replaced by a dealer	HIGH
Sublet Invoices	Scan/cal, alignment, glass, tow, storage — all have supporting invoices attached	HIGH
Shop Info	Name, address, phone, registration number complete — or 'Owner's Choice'	HIGH
Tax Config	Rates tab verified — rate matches ZIP, categories correct before locking	MEDIUM
Total Loss	NADA Normal Trade-In value (not Clean Retail); attach on borderline files	HIGH
Hail — Residence	Conservative estimate; PDR is preferred repair philosophy at residence	HIGH

AREA	WHAT TO CHECK	RISK
Hail — Photos	Striped board or checker board used; dent locations clearly visible	HIGH
Hail — PDR	CCC PDR Matrix only; no manual PDR lines, no aluminum/glue pull/oversized markups	HIGH
Hail — Windshield	Replace only if hail caused the break — rock chips do not qualify	MEDIUM
Questions	Anything unclear? Contact Rachael or Tommy before submitting	LOW

Questions? Contact Rachael or Tommy before submitting.